



WINTER IN OUR BONES
WATER TO OUR SOULS

Michigan is a folksy pop rock musical that follows Petoskey Vandam and Lulu Abughosh, a grieving Yooper boy and Dearborn girl, fight a data center to save their grandparents' historic lake house.

Michigan

Inspired by
The MacGregor Family
David Quang Pham's Childhood

&

In Loving Memory of
Carly Glynn
September 24, 1992 - February 10, 2011
Jeremy Swiatek
April 23, 1996 - September 15, 2019
Tiffany Marie Emmert
April 29, 1996 - January 19, 2026
James Emmert
May 5, 1991 - January 19, 2026
Andrew "Andy" Van Otteren
March 17, 1994 - July 12, 2026

Thanks to you all, David and countless others
love musical theatre and Michigan.

Michigan

SYNOPSIS

Set during a family reunion in Elk Rapids, this coming-of-age musical follows Lulu and Petoskey - a Dearborn city girl and Yooper farm boy – as they stop a data center from taking over their grandparents' lake house and save the entire city. Our rock star Lulu dreams of having a spiritual connection to the land and her rocks like Petoskey has. Meanwhile, our grieving Petoskey hopes to get to know his late father and help his mother heal through water. Petoskey, the state stone and native fossil that reveals its true pattern when wet, serves as a metaphor for hidden grief and emotional depth. Lulu, “pearl” in Arabic, like all pearls who try to break out of their shells.

Michigan is inspired by David Quang Pham's upbringing and the MacGregors who invite him to their Elk Rapids lake house on Harbor Days since being roommates with their family member Lukas Jacob in 2014. In 2026, after a series of suicides of his hometown and college friends in musical theatre, he began writing this musical as a love letter to his family and communities in our home Mitten.

WHY NOW?

Michigan champions human creativity, connections, and nature against the rise of harmful technologies, symbolized by the threat of a data center replacing a small-town family's lake house. By centering the narrative on the impacts of suicide and collective loss, the play addresses today's mental health crisis, offering ways to heal through open communication and community. And it uses science and folklore to bridge regional cultural divides, reminding audiences to protect both the natural environments and our shared heritages that keep us rooted.

Michigan is *Oklahoma* craziness meets *Fun Home* tenderness meets *Bright Star* folksiness.

Michigan

THEMES

Collective Grief and Emotional Healing

The story explores the long-term impact of grief after Petey's suicide and Grandma Milly's death, demonstrating how silence fractures families while open communication fosters generational healing.

Community versus Technology

The central conflict pits a warm hand-made tradition against cold corporate greed, by keeping AI data centers from erasing local heritage, such as the family's lake house.

Geographic and Cultural Disconnection

The narrative highlights how families can become polarized by peninsulas, symbolized by the physical and emotional barrier of the Mackinac Bridge separating the Upper and Lower Peninsula identities. The story leans into subcultures, contrasting Yooper (Upper Peninsula) against suburban Dearborn/Lower Peninsula dynamics.

Belonging and Identity

Through Lulu's competitive drive to outshine her cousins, the musical examines the painful adolescent struggle to fit into a Midwest family dynamic and find one's own sense of worth.

Nature, Folklore, and Science Literacy

By embedding paleontology into the musical numbers, the narrative uses the natural history of the Petoskey stone fossil to teach environmental appreciation and show how memories attach themselves to physical landscapes.

Michigan

The Immigrant Experience

This manifests through multiple layers, such as Shelby marrying an Arab man, Jasper Tran's Vietnamese restaurant (Banh MiMichigan), and Jasper's realization that his refugee family stayed united across continents while local families are divided by peninsulas. It deals heavily with how different minority communities interact within the Midwest.

Economic Displacement and Xenophobia

The backstory reveals the harsh realities of blue-collar job loss during the 2008 recession, like David's family in the automotive industry. It directly addresses the displaced anger that can arise from automated or immigrant replacement (Petey being fired and replaced by a migrant worker), showing the tragic intersection of economic desperation, racial tension, and family fallout.

The Power of Hand-Made Artistry

The family's century-old Ford Model T, their decades of hand-made costumes, and the town's rally around them showcase art and weirdness as a form of liberation.

Michigan

PLOT SUMMARY

Michigan is a folksy musical dramedy set at a family reunion where two rival cousins fight a data center to save their grandparents' historic lake house. The themes explore grief, cultural disconnection of the peninsulas, and what it means to be a Michigander.

Grampy Willy and Granny Milly live in Elk Rapids on the north tip of the Lower Peninsula. They have four adult children – Cherry, Perry, Shelby, and the only son Petey, and some grandchildren. Every August, their lake house lodges them for the annual Harbor Days. The Vandam family are known for their century-old Ford Model T, wearing themed costumes for the parade, and winning every Most Creative Award (“[The Mitten Song](#)”).

In 2008, Petey lives with his pregnant wife Lizzie in the Upper Peninsula. His childhood friend is Jasper Tran, who runs the Elk Rapids Vietnamese restaurant, BANH MICHIGAN. On a swim, he jokily promises to name their kid after the first rock he picks up, which turns out to be a heart-shaped Petoskey with an elk symbol (“[Life is Complete](#)”).

With the recession, their shipyard job fires and replaces Petey and Liz with migrants. He then hurts his little sister Shelby due to her Arab husband. In a storm, he drives off the Mackinac Bridge to save their house on his life insurance. A detective finds his Petoskey. Ever since, Liz refuses to cross bridges, missing all family gatherings (“[Body of Water](#)”).

For family reunions, the aunts take turns driving Petoskey to Elk Rapids then Milly drives him home. Jasper becomes his godfather. For every Mackinac Bridge crossing, he can hear his dad sing. And then there's his bright cousin from Dearborn, Lulu Abughosh. She always competes to find the rarest stones on their swims (“[Yoopers and Trolls](#)”).

In 2020, Milly passes away, cancelling the 2020 and 2021 family reunions. Soon, data center agent Amanda Wayland tricks a grieving Willy into signing away the deed to his house by using afterlife.ai to bring Milly and Petey back to life (“[It Would Be a Shame](#)”).

In 2022, to honor Milly, 13-year-old Petoskey's mother returns for the first time since the 2008 tragedy. They drive the long way through Wisconsin. Jasper helps Petoskey, Lulu, and the other kids set up camp and go canoeing with them. He often takes some of their snacks as “dad tax.” The aunties take even more with “mom taxes” (“[Dad Tax](#)”).

As Willy believes Milly and Petey stayed alive by AI, they discover Wayland's plot to turn Elk Lake into a data center. She and Cherry were art school rivals. She tours the home and sees a photo of baby Petoskey with his hearty stone. She wants it. Worth more than the city itself, the boy promises to trade it for the deed (“[AI Does the Work for Me](#)”).

They have a day to find the necklace along Pine River (“[Wild Midwest](#)”). He revisits a memory of Lulu dropping the heirloom while they canoed in 2019, severing his dad's spiritual ties. So, he enlists the cousins to help find it, promising whoever finds the heirloom gets to decide what he wears next year. But no one finds it (“[More than Fine](#)”).

Michigan

Later that night on a dune, Lulu and Petoskey witness deer pass by their bonfire. He wishes to see his dad while she hopes to beat Petoskey ("Dearborn"). Next day, while Perry teaches fossils to the kids ("Fossils in the Stones"), Lulu separates and discovers a deer dropping off the heirloom and other rare rocks on the shore ("Gichigamiin").

For Harbor Days' parade, Broadway actor cousin Jacob Jacobowitz is the Grand Marshal. So, the theme is theatre. Petoskey dresses as *Oklahoma's* Jud Fry while Lulu plays Evan Hansen. Before marching, she shows her rare findings to the family. To spite Petoskey, she breaks his father's necklace, unaware it was their only chance to save the lake house from Wayland. The parade goes wrong as Petoskey beats up Lulu, disqualifying them for the first time ("Fraudway"). After his mom lectures him, he runs off ("[Kick Rocks](#)").

In the following act, the family revisits a memory of Lulu and Petoskey meeting ("[Hands Come in Handy](#)"). Presently, they search for him while Lulu tries to find him at Banh MI ("Petoskey"). Jasper shares his refugee family stayed united despite continents dividing them as well as a time when a Lebanese family bought out his family's failing restaurant but did not resort to blame as Petey had. The Vandams are only divided by peninsulas. Lulu realizes Petoskey is most likely at the Mackinac Bridge ("[North South East West](#)").

They drive up to find him. She offers the broken stone as a truce, but he tosses it into the water ("Rock Bottom"). This causes the bridge to fog up where his father's ghost emerges as a giant elk. Petey shares that stones are special only when rocks are packed together. Like family, rocks come and go to leave a mark ("Family's in the Fossils").

They return to the fair where Wayland is exhibiting data center models with other developers. Petoskey offers the Ford which she scoffs but is interested in. Jasper then offers his restaurant. The Vandams return with decades of themed costume while Wayland shows how much "better" AI is. But the town rallies for this genuinely creative and weird family, against AI's goal of turning lakes into data centers. Wayland and the developers refuse and steal the Ford, causing the town to chase after them. She drives it off a bridge, then gets thrown into an asylum by Traverse City. Their contracts are declared void as their party is declared insane ("Leave No Stones Unturned").

After Harbor Days conclude, Liz takes the Ford for a spin and go the short way to the Mackinac Bridge, the first time since Petey's death. Liz and Petey's ghost have their own reunion as lovers once more ("[Water to My Soul](#)").

Years later, Willy passes away. Lulu and Petoskey buy and fix up the lake house. On January 26, 2037, Lansing holds a parade to celebrate the 200th anniversary of MI's statehood with representatives from every city marching. The theme is Pure Michigan. Representing Elk Rapids, the Vandam family resembles the state's best ("[Michigan](#)").

Michigan

CAST OF CHARACTERS

THE VANDAM FAMILY

PETOSKEY VANDAM is a 13-year-old farm boy from Skandia and the goofiest of Willy and Milly's grandkids. Besides his mom Liz, his only connection to extended family happens on Harbor Days in Elk Rapids. He never met his late father. To honor Petey, he wears his heart-shaped Petoskey heirloom with an elk symbol.

LIZZIE VANDAM is Petoskey's mother and narrator in Skandia. After her husband Petey's suicide in 2008, she stops crossing the Mackinac Bridge to attend Harbor Days and all family gatherings. Liz is a proud farm girl Yooper. Michigan State.

PETEY VANDAM is Petoskey's father, Liz's husband, and Willy and Milly's only son of four. Every Harbor Days, he would be the first to get up to wake everyone up. During the recession, his blue-collar shipyard job fires and replaces him and Liz with migrants, leading to a fight with his little sister Shelby for marrying an Arab. He drives off the Mackinac Bridge to save their house with his life insurance. His ghost visits Petoskey whenever he crosses the bridge. Michigan State.

LULU ABUGHOSH is a 13-year-old city girl from Dearborn and the brightest of Willy and Milly grandkids, yet she is trollface personified. She hopes to beat cousin Petoskey in their annual rare rocks collection. She is writing a musical titled *Dearborn*, about a family of deer navigating the anthropomorphic Great Lakes. She plays banjo and is Iggy Pop's biggest fan. Her name is Arabic meaning "pearl."

SHELBY ABUGHOSH is Petoskey's aunt, Petey's little sister, and Lulu's mother who lives in Dearborn. She is an automotive worker for Ford Motor Company. As the sister who broke the mold by falling in love with an Arab, she and Petey had a tumultuous relationship. She tries to respect Petoskey. Kettering University.

PERRY VANDAM is Petoskey's aunt and Petey's older sister in Lansing. Her campy mind loves science. Michigan Technological University dropout.

CHERRY JACOBOWITZ is Petoskey's aunt and Petey's oldest sister in Kalamazoo. She arranges the theme and costumes for the annual Harbor Days parade. She is married to a Grand Rapids Griffins hockey manager. Hope College.

JACOB JACOBOWITZ is Cherry's son who is a Broadway actor in New York. He is the 2022 Grand Marshal for the Harbor Days Grande Parade where he is dressed as Wednesday from *The Addams Family*. He recently performed on the national tour of this show. Western Michigan University.

Michigan

LIBERTY AND BAILEY are twin siblings and Petoskey, Lulu, and Jacob's little cousins removed from reality. They are from Hell... Michigan. Liberty is allergic to sand and Bailey is allergic to pine. They make poison ivy bouquets.

MILLY VANDAM is Petoskey's bold grandmother and inventor. She invented the automatic toilet. With Willy, she owns a house by Elk Lake in Elk Rapids. She and Willy stumble into the audience every so often. Central Michigan University.

WILLY VANDAM is Petoskey's chill grandfather and gardener. With Milly, he owns a lake house by Elk Lake in Elk Rapids. Grieving Milly's death in 2020, he leaves the garden unattended and accidentally signs away the deed. He and Milly stumble into the audience every so often. Northern Michigan University.

ELK RAPIDS RESIDENTS

JASPER TRAN is Petey's resourceful childhood friend and Petoskey's godfather who runs the BANH Michigan Vietnamese restaurant and a golf course. As a teen, he once looked down on the Arab community when a Lebanese family bought out his family's previous struggling restaurant. After Petey's death with his last memory being his prejudice towards Arabs for "stealing American jobs," he vows to help migrants no matter what. Ferris State. Red Wings fan.

AMANDA WAYLAND is the CEO of Turkey Ventures from Muskegon who created afterlife.ai with the goal of turning every city into a data center. At Hope College, she was an art school rival of Cherry Vandam, before getting expelled for using Photoshop. So, she sees the Vandam family's hands-on creativity as inferior to the efficiency of AI. The Vandams describe her as a turkey vulture. But like most of the world, there is one thing she likes more than data and that is a cool rock, which Petoskey holds. Hope College dropout. University of Michigan (ew).

MICHIGANDERS

DETECTIVE is an investigator along the Mackinac Bridge.

THE GHOST OF HENRY FORD returns from Hell.

COPS, OLIGARCHS

Michigan

MUSICAL NUMBERS

ACT I

1. [Overture / The Mitten Song](#) Petey
2. [Life is Complete](#) The Vandams
3. [Body of Water](#) Petey, Lizzie
4. [Yoopers and Trolls](#) Petoskey, Lulu
5. [It Would Be a Shame](#) Wayland, Willy, Milly, Petey
6. [Dad Tax](#) Jasper, Lizzie, Cherry, Perry, Shelby, Lulu, Petoskey, Kids
7. [Al Does the Work for Me](#) Wayland, The Vandams
8. [Wild Midwest](#) Jacob, Petoskey, Lulu, Liberty, Bailey, Cousins
9. [More than Fine \(I'm Pine\)](#) Jacob, Petoskey, Lulu, Liberty, Bailey, Cousins
10. Dearborn (Dear Deer) Petoskey, Lulu, Deer
11. Fossils in the Stones 🖐️ Perry, Kids
12. Gichigamiin (The Great Lakes Ballet) Company
13. Fraudway Company
14. [Kick Rocks](#) The Vandams

ACT II

15. [Hands Come in Handy](#) Lulu, Petoskey
16. Petoskey Company
17. [North South East West](#) Jasper, Lulu
18. Rock Bottom Petoskey, Lulu
19. Family's in the Fossils Petey, Petoskey
20. Leave No Stones Unturned Wayland, The Vandams, Residents
21. [Water to My Soul](#) Lizzie, Petey
22. [Michigan](#) Michiganders

🖐️ “Fossils in the Stones” is a David Quang Pham signature science song teaching paleontology.

[Nayaano](#)

Main Theme

[Water Spirits](#)

Childhood Theme

[Lake Giants](#)

Adulthood Theme

[Pine Monsters](#)

Troublesome Theme

PROLOGUE

EXT. ELK LAKE HOUSE IN ELK RAPIDS, AUGUST 2008 - DAY

1. "OVERTURE/THE MITTEN SONG"

In the wooded backyard are tents where the Vandam family is camping next to Elk Lake's rocky shores.

PETHEY (30s, man who's seen better days) crawls out of his tent. He puts on mittens. With a melodic yawn, he bangs pots and pans.

PETHEY

WAKEY WAKEY, SUN.
LET'S WEAR OUR MITTENS
AND COOK 'EM EGGS WITH LOTSA BACON
FOR OUR GODSEND, MICHIGAN!
SLEPT WELL, HUN...?

LIZZIE (30s, pregnant narrator) crawls out of Petey's tent, ready to smack her noisy hubby.

End of "OVERTURE/THE MITTEN SONG"

2. "LIFE IS COMPLETE"

LIZZIE

THAT'S THE LOVE OF MY LIFE.
BUT EVERY MORNING, HE'S PUBLIC ENEMY NUMBER ONE.

The three Vandam sisters - CHERRY, PERRY, and SHELBY (pregnant) - crawl out of their tents.

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY

TO HIS WIFE, LIZZIE...

PETHEY

AND ONE TWO AND THREE GODDAM SISTERS!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY

THE VANDAM SISTERS!

CHERRY

CHERRY!

PERRY

PERRY!

SHELBY

SHELBY!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY

WET WILLY!

The sisters give bro a wet willy!

PETEEY

Eeeekkkkk!!!

GRANNY MILLY and GRAMPY WILLY roam
in the audience, giving no F&*@s.

WILLY

DID SOMEONE SAY WET WILLY?!

MILLY

OR WET MILLY?

PETEEY, CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY

EW... MOM AND DAD, THAT'S GROSS!

WILLY

WHAT?!

MILLY

HUH?!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY

GO PUT ON YOUR HEARING AIDS.

Willy-Milly tune their hearing
aids. They frolic in the audience.

WILLY & MILLY

GREAT!

MILLY

GRAMPY WILLY.
WE'VE GOT COMPANY.

WILLY

GRANNY MILLY.
REAL GOOD COMPANY.

WILLY & MILLY

ISN'T LIFE SOMETHIN'?

MILLY

YOU HAVE COME A LONG WAY, FRIENDS.

WILLY

TO THE GREATEST BAY IN ALL THE GREAT LAKES!

MILLY

BAKED YOUR KIDS FRESH COOKIES,
MAKE YOURSELF COMFY.

Milly hands out cookies. Willy
removes his shoes. The pit pukes.

MILLY (CONT'D)

Ugh! Ya scaring our guests with your clam feet!

WILLY

I've been working out. My legs are full of mussels. M-U-S-S-E-L-S? Get it?

MILLY

Your dad jokes are getting old, Grampy Willy.

WILLY

Not as old as you, Granny Milly...

MILLY

Shush! The guests are gonna think we're Midwest silly instead of normal silly.

PETEEY

Ma! Pa! Who are you talking to???

LIZZIE

You should put ya parents in a retirement h-

WILLY & MILLY

Our hearing aids heard that! Maestro?!
(to the Conductor)

LIFE IS COMPLETE WITH OUR CRAZY FAMILY!

The Vandams put on Red Wings gear.

LIZZIE

Welcome to Harbor Days with the Vandam family!
What's Harbor Days you ask? For four days in August, it's an Elk Rapids tradition. That's all I know. I've gone to these since Petey and I were high school sweethearts. We always tried to go even while tailgating Michigan State...

PETEEY

Go Green!

AUDIENCE MEMBER

Go White!

LIZZIE

...and I still have no clue what Harbor Days is even about.

CHERRY

It's about the parade, dear.

PERRY

Nah, it's about the carnival!

SHELBY

Actually, it's about the fireworks, yo!

WILLY & MILLY

It's about the Lake House.

WILLY

My genius, Milly. She invented the auto-toilet
then flushed her money to buy this Lake House.

MILLY

That ain't how you use the expression, sweetie.
Well, my creative Willy tends to our garden.

WILLY

Did you put a turtle in the koi pond?

MILLY

No, dear.

WILLY

Not *deer*. That *turtle* ate all the koi fish!

CHERRY

It's my son, Jacob. Little teenage rascal...

LIZZIE

That's Petey's oldest sister, Cherry
Jacobowitz. Her family's in Kalamazoo. She's a
costume designer and her hubby used to play
hockey with the Grand Rapids Griffins.

Cherry points to Kalamazoo using
her hand as Michigan.

CHERRY

The only pucks I give is winning the Most
Creative Award at the annual Grande Parade.

LIZZIE

Ever since she was little, Cherry would make
the family wear elaborate costumes.

PETEEY

What's this year's theme?

CHERRY

2008 is Red Wings.

PETEEY

They just beat Pittsburgh Penguins...

SHELBY

...to win the Stanley Cup. Woop!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY

Let's win that 2008 Most Creative Award!
NO ONE BEATS THE VANDAMS!

LIZZIE

No one beats us like this 2008 recession.
Michigan's been hit hard. Budget's tight.

(MORE)

LIZZIE (CONT'D)

The shipyard in Marquette fired me and Petey.
We can only hope that we don't lose our house.

PERRY

If this scavenger has kept her den, any other
coyote can.

LIZZIE

This is Perry. She and Petey are Willy and
Milly's middle children.

PERRY

I'm in the middle of greatness!

LIZZIE

Single. Can never hold up a job.

PERRY

I've been at Lansing Impression Science Center!

Perry shows Lansing on her hand.

LIZZIE

Welp, she's the smartest person I know.

SHELBY

What does that make me?

LIZZIE

Pregnancy sistahs!

SHELBY

Whoo yeah!

LIZZIE

And finally, Shelby, Petey's youngest sister.
How's Ford in Dearborn holding up?

Shelby shows Dearborn on her hand.

SHELBY

Assembly line's fine, thanks to my husband. He
was able to get his Kurdish buddies jobs. Sure,
they're getting paid minimum wage but what more
could one ask for in recession times?

PETEEY

Thanks America, letting illegals steal our jobs-

LIZZIE

Petey... Her husband ain't coming to Harbor
Days with that attitude of yours.

PETEEY

He got citizenship on our shores by marriage.
He'll dump her once the coast is clear.

SHELBY

Immigrants built the coasts, harbors, country.

The Michigan communities from the
Amish to Jewish, Christians to
Muslims, auto workers to farmers,
college fans to trade school folks
make themselves known.

MICHIGANDERS

OPE...

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY

LIFE AIN'T COMPLETE...

LIZZIE

WITHOUT...

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
COMMUNITY!

MICHIGANDERS
COMMUNITY!

MICHIGANDERS (CONT'D)

THE WORLD SITS ON OUR FURNITURE!
PEOPLE CAN GET ANYWHERE WITH OUR CARS!
OUR CHERRY FARMS ARE THE CHERRY ON TOP!

JASPER TRAN (30s, Vietnamese man)
opens up the BANH MI restaurant.

JASPER

AND LET'S NOT FORGET!

PETHEY

ELK RAPIDS HAS THE BEST
VIETNAMESE RESTAURANT!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY

MICHIGAN HAS THE BEST
VIETNAMESE COMMUNITY!

JASPER

IN THE WHOLE WORLD!

MICHIGANDERS

LIFE AIN'T COMPLETE WITHOUT BANH MI!

JASPER

BANH MIIIIIIIIIIIIICHIGAN!

MICHIGANDERS

SAY THAT AGAIN!

JASPER

BANH MICHIGAN!

BANH Michigan, a Vietnamese family-owned
restaurant in Elk Rapids, Michigan. Home to
Banh Mi Thit or the Nuong, Banh Mi Heo Quay,
Banh Mi Xiu Mai, Banh Mi Ga Nuong, and home to
our latest Detroit-style Banh Mi-

PETHEY

And it's what I called home. Jasper!

JASPER

Petey! Happy Harbor Days to you, and Lizzie,
and your soon-to-be baby!

LIZZIE

If you could put Banh Mi in baby formula,
you've got yourself your youngest customer.

JASPER

Way ahead of ya!

PETHEY

After the parade, come on by the Lake House for
a swim for o' time sake.

JASPER

Kosher Banh Mi for Cherry's son Jacob and
sourdough for Willy and Milly?

PETHEY

You're always able to make Banh Mi for
everyone.

JASPER

Cause Banh Mi is you and me!

Willy drives in the Ford Model T.

VANDAMS

LIFE AIN'T COMPLETE WITHOUT...

WILLY

OUR FORD MODEL T!

MICHIGANDERS

THE FORD MODEL T!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
DADDY GOT SOME WHEELIES.

MICHIGANDERS (CONT'D)
WILLY GOT SOME WHEELIES.

WILLY & MILLY
THIS BABY'S JUST A CENTURY YOUNG.

Liz, Petey, Shelby, and Jasper
hang out by Elk Lake.

LIZZIE

Watcha naming your daughter?

SHELBY

Lulu! It means "pearl." And your ibnuki (إبنك)?

Petey looks disgusted.

LIZZIE

Lulu is jameela (جميلة). No clue.

JASPER

I bet Petey's got an ace up his sleeves.

PETEY

More like *stone*.

Petey and Jasper hop into Elk Lake, splashing each other.

AMANDA WAYLAND (30s, all business)
briefly peaks in from a bush.

WAYLAND

Such a shame a happy family completes this Lake House when it's missing something. I mean, look at this water. Disgusting. Freely flowing when it should be cooling my supercomputers. The air... too pure to breathe. It needs the spicy flavor of nuclear power. All families are incomplete without pure dread. The Great Lakes do bring out the worst. The Vandams will burst.

PETEY

We won't name our son. A rock in Elk Lake will!

Petey dives into Elk Lake.

JASPER

Jasper! Jasper! Jasper!

LIZZIE

This gotta be a joke...

Petey resurfaces with a heart-shaped, Elk-marked Petoskey stone.

Michiganders assemble into gospel.

MICHIGANDERS

PETOSKEY...

PETOSKEY...

THE JEWEL OF MICHIGAN...

LIZZIE

WE AIN'T NAMING OUR SON THAT.

JASPER

How about naming your second kid, Jasper?!

PETEY

WE DON'T HAVE TO NAME HIM THAT.

LIZZIE

IT DOES SOUND LIKE PETEY.

PETHEY
MY NAME JUST NEEDS AN O AND A KEY-

Liz kisses Petey. They join the
rest of the family, marching in
the Harbor Days Grande Parade.

LIZZIE
ISN'T LIFE BEAUTIFUL?

PETHEY (CONT'D)
ISN'T LIFE WORTH LIVING?

VANDAMS
LIFE IS COMPLETE WITH OUR

MICHIGANDERS
LIFE IS COMPLETE WITH THIS

LIZZIE
CRAZY

PETHEY
SASSY

CHERRY
WORKY

PERRY
NERDY

SHELBY
DERPY

WILLY
WILLY

MILLY
LOVELY

JASPER & MICHIGANDERS
WELCOMING...

VANDAMS
FAMILY!

The Michiganders give Milly the
Most Creative Award plaque.

End of "LIFE IS COMPLETE"

Liz's phone rings. She answers.

LIZZIE
No! Please! Life is incomplete without it!

Liz slams her flip phone. She nod
at Petey. He holds her close.

PETHEY
Our house? No no no. Rest assured, all that
matters is that we have our lives ahead.

Liz lets go. She exits with
everyone clearing the parade.

PETHEY (CONT'D)
We ain't losing our house... I've got my life
insurance... Let's trade.

Elk Lake becomes Mackinac Strait.

EXT. MACKINAC BRIDGE - EVENING

3. "BODY OF WATER"

In the foggy storm, Petey ponders.

PETHEY
EVERY LIVING THING IS MADE OF WATER.
EVERY MACHINERY NEEDS THE FLOW OF WATER.
ALL THE WEATHER TAKE THE HEATED WATER.
ALL THE SEASONS BRING THE COOLING WATER.

I BRING NOTHING TO THE WORLD UNLIKE WATER.
I'VE BROUGHT NOTHING TO THE WORLD BUT TEARS!

The MACKINAC GHOSTS manifest,
resembling those who died there.

MACKINAC GHOSTS
DRINK IT. DRINK THE WATER.
THINK STRAIGHT. THINK STRAIGHTFORWARD.

PETHEY
I BRING NOTHING TO THE WORLD.

MACKINAC GHOSTS
CHERISH. CHERISH THIS ONE LIFE.

PETHEY
JUST TEARS!
HELP!

The Ghosts steal Petey's stone.

MACKINAC GHOSTS
HELP? HELL, HELP YOURSELF!

A Motherly Ghost returns with a
Petoskey necklace. Petey wears it.

PETHEY
I CHOOSE LIFE!

MACKINAC GHOSTS (CONT'D)
TAKE IT IN.

PETHEY (CONT'D)
DRINK THE GREAT LAKES WATER.
THINK PAIN. PAIN YOU'LL CAUSE.
HAPPY WIFE. BABY IN SIGHT. DYING AIN'T RIGHT.

MACKINAC GHOSTS

DRINK IT. DRINK THE WATER.
THINK STRAIGHT. THINK STRAIGHTFORWARD.
CHERISH. CHERISH LIGHT.

PETHEY

HELP MYSELF TO THIS GREAT WATER!

Petey drives the car away.

Morning approaches with emergency
vehicles. The orchestra wails.

Liz rushes in with the DETECTIVE.
She stops in her tracks, kneeling.

LIZZIE

LIFE IS A COMPLETE... DISASTER...
LIFE IS INCOMPLETE WITHOUT PETE-

DETECTIVE

WE ARE SORRY TO REPORT THE CAR SUBMERGED UNDER MACKINAC
BRIDGE IS IDENTIFIED AS YOURS...

LIZZIE

AND...?

DETECTIVE

NO BODIES.
NOBODY.

The Detective hands the Petoskey
necklace to Liz, then leaves.

LIZZIE

NOBODY LOVES ME LIKE THIS BODY OF WATER...

Petey manifests.

MACKINAC GHOSTS (V.O.)

NOBODY...

LIZZIE

WITH MY LAST TEAR, I'M OUT OF WATER IN MY HEART.

PETHEY

YOU ARE MY SOUL.

MACKINAC GHOSTS (V.O.)

NOBODY...

Petey closes Liz's hand, sealing
the Petoskey. Then, he vanishes.

End of "BODY OF WATER"

LIZZIE

Water is under the bridge, but I'll never set foot on what double-crossed my heart. Bridges are supposed to unite lands, not divide souls. Our house has been spared thanks to my hubby's life insurance. But I didn't mind losing *what* is called home when it meant losing *who* I called home. I just wanna sink like a rock...

Shelby, bruised up, enters and embraces Liz on the ground.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)

Every rock has a soft spot, like my son...

Liz places the Petoskey necklace down (now called the "Heirloom").

Shelby helps the grieving Liz exit.

END OF PROLOGUE

ACT ISCENE 1

EXT. ELK LAKE HOUSE IN ELK RAPIDS, AUGUST 2019 - DAY

4. "YOOPERS AND TROLLS"

PETOSKEY (11, farm boy in a flat hat) crawls out of his tent. He puts on the Heirloom and mittens. He bangs pots and pans.

LULU (11, city gal in a headscarf) crawls out of her tent and trolls.

LULU
...Petoskey!

PETOSKEY
Lulu!

LULU
Shut up, Yooper!

PETOSKEY (CONT'D)
Pipe down, Troll.

Cherry, Perry, and Shelby enter.

CHERRY
Kids at it again?

SHELBY
With my daughter, you betcha.

PERRY
Let's be responsible... and place some bets.

SHELBY
Let's go Lulu! Your inheritance in on the line!

PETOSKEY
HOLY WAH! ANOTHER DAY TO GO FISHING!

LULU
YEAH NO... TODAY, WE GO BIRD WATCHING.

PETOSKEY
AREN'T YOU FROM EH... DEARBORN?

LULU
I AIN'T INTO DEER, YOU WILD YOOPERS...

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
UNDER THE BRIDGE.
OVER THE MITTEN.
YOOPERS AND TROLLS.

LULU
HOLY CRAP, I HATE *HATE* CAMPING WITH YOU.

PETOSKEY
NO ONE LIKES YOUR HIP HOP TRASH.

LULU
TAKE IT BACK, COUNTRY BOY.

PETOSKEY
YOU FIRST, CITY GAL.

LULU & PETOSKEY
ANOTHER HARBOR DAYS...

LULU
...WITH THIS WILD YOOOPER...

Lulu and Petoskey wrestle.

PETOSKEY
STAY UNDER THE BRIDGE, TROLL!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
YOOPERS AND TROLLS FORM A BRIDGE!

WILLY & MILLY
STOP FIGHTING!

End of "YOOPERS AND TROLLS"

LIZZIE
(Narrating)
If my rock and his cousin Lulu ain't fighting,
I'd assume aliens have replaced them. The whole
family's weird. There's cousin Jacob Jacobowitz
who is making it on Broadway. Then Liberty and
Bailey. Twin cousins from Hell... Michigan.
I've heard from my in-laws they are angels.

Liberty and Bailey go buck wild
and chase everyone around.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)
I don't remember the other cousins Petoskey
mentioned. They got many cousins, aunts, uncles-
I wish I could meet them all but that Mackinac.
It's a bridge I cannot cross. Its watery depths
crossed my heart and made many hope to die.

Cherry drives in. Petoskey sits.
Then Perry takes over and gives
him homework. Then Shelby and Lulu
shove Perry and Petoskey out. Then
Granny Milly respectfully takes
over and lets him in the car.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)

Fortunately, my son is able to. His aunties have no problem taking turns driving him from the U P to the L P. After Harbor Days, Granny Milly drives him home or insane. He is said to hear a man's voice whenever they cross-

As Petoskey naps in the car, he awakens to Petey's song.

PETEY (V.O.)

WAKEY WAKEY, SON...

Jasper takes over for Milly. He drops off Petoskey in Skandia. Liz sees Jasper become his godfather.

LIZZIE

Whenever Milly wasn't feeling well, Petoskey was Jasper's problem. Ugh, boys...

Then the real problem came in 2020. We didn't see it coming. No longer saw another of Milly's inventions from automatic toilets to magnetic pet hair removers. No more crazy ideas. Grampy Willy canceled family reunions in 2020 to 2021. He needed to grieve alone. I worry for him and the Lake House. I'm thankful for our home, living off hubby's life insurance. But life still take lives. I needed to see everyone.

Petoskey looks at photos of Milly.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)

Son, I know how much Grammy Milly meant to you. So, would it mean the world if I went to this year's Harbor Days? August two ol' two two.

PETOSKEY

You'd cross the bridge?

LIZZIE

Nah. We'll take the long way through Wisconsin.

PETOSKEY

That's not fair! Everyone's cheesy there...

LIZZIE

Let's get a MOOooooove on. For Milly's sake.

Liz and Petoskey exit.

SCENE 2

INT. ELK LAKE HOUSE - LIVING ROOM, AUGUST 2022 - DAY

5. "IT WOULD BE A SHAME"

Willy stares longingly at a photo
of his late wife Milly.

Amanda Wayland knocks on the door.
Willy goes open it, then slams it.

WAYLAND
I NEED YOUR LAKE HOUSE!

WILLY
YOU DAMN VULTURE.

MILLY (V.O.)
WHO ARE YOU CALLING A VULTURE?

Willy opens the door again.
Wayland nabs Milly's photo and
sets it on her tablet.

WAYLAND
AND YOU NEED YOUR WIFE BACK.
MY NAME'S AMANDA WAYLAND OF TURKEY VENTURES...
AND I CAN BRING YOUR WIFE TO LIFE!

WILLY
SHE DID NOT BELIEVE IN ALCHEMY.

WAYLAND
THIS IS NOT ALCHEMY.
IT IS TECHNOLOGY!

Milly shows up behind Wayland.

MILLY
SO PROUD OF YOU.

WAYLAND
(Raising the tablet volume)
YOU HEARD THAT?

MILLY
I LOVE YOU!!

WAYLAND
I'D LOVE FOR YOU TO LET ME BUILD A DATA CENTER BY YOUR LAKE.
SO, SHE CAN GET THE WATER SHE NEEDS.

MILLY
DO NOT BRING SHAME.

Willy looks at the disapproving
violinists in the orchestra.

WAYLAND
DON'T BE ASHAMED TO SAY "NO."

WILLY
NO.

Milly disappears.

Wayland expects it. She "respects"
his choice. Before going, she nabs
a photo. Outside, she sets it on
her tablet. Petey enters the home.

PETEEY
WASN'T MY LIFE WORTH MORE THAN MY HOUSE?

MILLY
IT'D BE A SHAME...

PETEEY
WASN'T MY BREATH WORTH MORE THAN SOME LAKE?

MILLY
IT'D BE A SHAME...

PETEEY
WASN'T MY HEART WORTH MORE THAN THESE ROCKS?

WILLY
THERE IS NO SHAME IN FORGETTING THEM.

Milly joins Petey.

PETEEY, MILLY, WAYLAND
SHAME...
SHAME...
ASHAMED...
ONLY SHAME...
NOTHING STAYS THE SAME...

WILLY
IT WOULD BE A SHAME IF I CHOSE THE HOUSE BEFORE MY FAMILY!
IT WOULD BE A SHAME IF I MAKE...

WAYLAND
BRING BACK YOUR WIFE!

PETEEY & MILLY
DON'T BE ASHAMED!

WILLY
IT'D BE A SHAME IF I MAKE THE...

PETEEY & MILLY
THERE IS NO SHAME.

WAYLAND
BRING BACK YOUR SON!

WILLY
IT'D BE A SHAME IF I MAKE THE SAME...

PETHEY, MILLY, WAYLAND
NOTHING STAYS THE SAME...

WILLY
IT'D BE SHAME IF I MAKE THE SAME MISTAKE...

WAYLAND
IT'D BE A SHAME IF YOU MADE THE SAME...

PETHEY, MILLY, WAYLAND
IT'D BE A SHAME!

Milly and Petey vanish before
Willy hugs them. Instead, he holds
a tablet, displaying a contract.

End of "IT WOULD BE A SHAME"

SCENE 3

EXT. ELK LAKE HOUSE IN ELK RAPIDS - DAY

6. "DAD TAX"

Jasper finishes setting up tents.

Shelby and Lizzie stare in awe as
Lulu and Petoskey feel awful.

SHELBY
Thanks for everything, Jasper.

LULU
I really did not need your help.

PETOSKEY
You needed all the help you can get, Lulu.

JASPER
And you needed manpower.

LULU
Ha! He called you a sissy, Petoskey!

LIZZIE
How could we ever repay you?

JASPER
Your sweetness is good 'nough for me.

Jasper nabs a handful of candy
from Lulu and Petoskey's box.

LULU & PETOSKEY

That's *my* candy.

Lulu and Petoskey stare down one
another as they fight for the box.

LULU & PETOSKEY (CONT'D)

Mine! My sweets! Sugar! Mine!

Jasper takes their box away.

JASPER

In the jurisdiction vested by the council of
fathers and godfathers, everything is mine.

LULU & PETOSKEY

What jurisdiction?

Jasper pulls out his "Dad Rules!"
book. He opens it for the kids to
skim then promptly shuts it.

JASPER

YOU KIDS GOT NO SAY...

LULU, PETOSKEY, KIDS

SO TAXATION WITHOUT REPRESENTATION?

JASPER

IT'S GOOD FOR THE COMMUNITY!

LULU, PETOSKEY, KIDS

THAT'S WHAT A COMMUNIST WOULD SAY!

JASPER

JUST PAY YOUR FAIR SHARE!

LULU, PETOSKEY, KIDS

NEVER!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY

DAD RULES!
TAX SEASON!
CAMP REASONS!
COME COLLECT:

[The Vandam aunties tax and
collect from the kids on Jasper's
behalf.]

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY (CONT'D)	LULU, PETOSKEY, KIDS
YOUR COOKIES!	MY COOKIES!
YOUR CANDIES!	MY CANDY!
YOUR FRENCH FRIES!	MY FRENCH FRIES!
YOUR MILK SHAKES!	MY MILK SHAKE!
YOUR CHICKEN!	MY CHICKEN!
YOUR NUGGETS!	MY NUGGETS!
YOUR KID'S MEALS!	MY KID'S MEAL!
YOUR ROBLOX!	MY ROBLOX!
YOUR MINECRAFT!	MY MINECRAFT!
YOUR FREEDOM!	OUR CIVIL LIBERTIES!

JASPER
YOU'VE GOT TRANSPORTATION...
DRINKING WATER...

Jasper drinks the milk shakes.

JASPER (CONT'D)
THERE'RE NOW CAMP GOODS AND SERVICES...
ALL THANKS TO THE DAD TAX!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
PAY YOUR DAD TAX!

[Liz sings about the mom tax. It is more egregious than the dad tax. The kids start a Boston Tea Party-esque revolution due to being dad and mom taxed without kid representation.]

Jasper, the Vandam sisters, and
the kids gather by the bonfire.

JASPER

Looks like during the revolution, you all
started the fire! A perfect bonfire to honor
Grammy Milly. I'll go get Grampy Willy.

Jasper goes into the Lake House.

LULU

One can only wish for a godfather like Jasper.

PETOSKEY

You just saw him and our moms tax us.

LIZZIE & SHELBY

We gave you welfare in the world, we can tax
you out of it.

Jasper enters with Willy. He pulls
up a chair.

JASPER

Why don't you have a seat here?

Willy sits. Everyone sits down.

CHERRY

We gather here today to honor the life of
Grammy Milly. It's been a couple years since
Milly left this world...

WILLY

Actually, Milly came back a couple days ago.

Everyone stares at Willy like an
old man who lost his marbles.

PERRY

Like in your dreams?

SHELBY

Putting him in a nursing home is gonna be a
nightmare.

Willy pulls out a tablet.

WILLY

Home is here. So is my favorite nurse... on
this phone.

PERRY

That's too big for a phone.

CHERRY

It's how big they were back then.

SHELBY

Dad, you can't just call the after life.

WILLY

Milly, please call.

Milly appears on the tablet.

MILLY

Way ahead of you.

Everyone is disturbed.

LULU, PETOSKEY, KIDS

She looks so real!

WILLY

She is.

PERRY

No, she's not.

CHERRY

She... Don't break dad's heart again.

WILLY

You all have seen enough of your mama. I can ask Petey to call.

Liz covers Petoskey's eyes.

LIZZIE

No no no.

JASPER

What did this cost?

WILLY

Very little.

CHERRY

How much?

WILLY

My son was worth more than...

LIZZIE

...the house...?!

Wayland slyly steps in.

WAYLAND

Yes, access to Afterlife dot AI was on the house. I see it's a perfect time to come in when everyone seems fired up. Cherry.

CHERRY

Amanda...

WAYLAND

How's making 'em kiddo costumes for your dumb Harbor Days parade?

CHERRY

How's making anything? That's right. You can't.

LULU

Who's she?

PERRY

Amanda Wayland was Cherry's classmate in Hope College art school.

CHERRY

Until she was caught cheating with Photoshop.

WAYLAND

And now everyone's using Photoshop.

SHELBY

Don't you use that, Cherry?

CHERRY

Shut up. I use Corel.

PERRY

You geezer. Who uses Corel?

WAYLAND

And I did complete my degree at U of M.

VANDAMS

Ew... The Wolverines.

KIDS

Rabies...

WAYLAND

Bite me. Now, everyone around the world depends on me to get through the day, answer questions smart or dumb, read novels, write essays, entire musicals-

LULU & JACOB

Shut the f-

CHERRY & SHELBY

Language.

WAYLAND

I didn't get to the best part of. It does the impossible. It brings the dead to life.

PETOSKEY

Deadarse...

Everyone stares down Liz.

LIZZIE

We Yoopers do not police language.

CHERRY

Get out.

WAYLAND

You're impressed.

PERRY

Depressed. Seriously, get out.

SHELBY

Vamos!

JASPER

Willy, implore this morally ambiguous woman to leave the premises.

WAYLAND

The premise is... I own your Lake House. There's a Willy, there's a way. Willy, thanks for not making the same mistake your son made.

CHERRY

To maintain the premises...

7. "AI DOES THE WORK FOR ME"

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY

Who will do the hard work?

WAYLAND

A I!!!

Wayland releases a bunch of physical embodiments of AI slop.

VANDAMS

THAT IS CRAZY!

WAYLAND

LISTEN, FREAKS. I'M NOT YOUR ENEMY!

[Wayland explains the power of a
data center.]

WAYLAND (CONT'D)
DON'T MISS THIS GREAT OPPORTUNITY!

VANDAMS EXCEPT CHERRY
IT'S FREE?

WAYLAND
SO FREE.

CHERRY
THIS IS SLAVERY.

VANDAMS EXCEPT CHERRY
REALLY?

WAYLAND
BUT DIRT CHEAP!

VANDAMS EXCEPT CHERRY
LET'S CHEAT!

CHERRY
THE BILL FOR ELECTRICITY?

WAYLAND
SPEAKING OF CITY!

[There is a montage of Wayland
stealing away every home in every
city in Michigan.]

WAYLAND (CONT'D)

AI'S DOING THE WORK FOR ME!

I'LL MAKE HISTORY WITH DATA CENTERS IN ALL CITIES!

AI MAY GROW A CONSCIENCE BEFORE ANYONE OF US WILL REALIZE...

OH WELL...

AI'S GONNA MAKE ME LOTSA MONEY!

I'LL MAKE HISTORY WITH DATA CENTERS IN ALL CITIES!

MAYBE I WILL GROW A CONSCIENCE BEFORE ANYONE OF YOU SPREAD
LIES...

NO WAY...

AI DOES THE WORK FOR ME!

End of "AI DOES THE WORK FOR ME"

PETOSKEY

Wow... Yas, Kween!

Jacob slaps Petoskey's shoulder.

JACOB

Don't use "Kween" in a straight way ever again.

WAYLAND

As your "Kween," I am entitled to a tour of your shanty palace.

Cherry is about to lead Wayland.

WAYLAND (CONT'D)

No no no. I only give access to those who showed some respect around here. Crystal?

PETOSKEY

Petoskey.

WAYLAND

Okay. Pebble.

PETOSKEY

May I bring my mom?

Petoskey and Liz lead Wayland into the Lake House.

SCENE 6

INT. ELK LAKE HOUSE IN ELK RAPIDS - EVENING

The walls are full of photos.

Petoskey and Liz guide Wayland around the Lake House.

WAYLAND

My guys will help preserve these photos. Don't you worry about it.

LIZZIE

You'll give them back, right?

WAYLAND

No. And the digital prints will be behind a paywall.

PETOSKEY

What's a paywall?

LIZZIE

It's the reason so many people in this state
get their news from conspiracy theorists online
instead of reading MLive or Detroit *Free Press*.

7A. "LIFE IS COMPLETE - REPRISE"

WAYLAND

What's that?

LIZZIE

I thought you're the know-all of capitalism.

Wayland points at a photo of young
Petoskey wearing his father's
heirloom: a heart-shaped Petoskey
stone with a marking of an Elk.

WAYLAND

No... That.

LIZZIE

It's my late husband's heirloom.

PETOSKEY

It's what I'm named after.

WAYLAND

You outgrew it? Well, no one outgrows cool
rocks, especially a Petoskey. This one seems
like it's worth a whole Great Lake. No... It's
an heirloom. Your dead husband makes this worth
two Great Lakes. Unlike him, is it here?

CHERRY & PERRY

Somewhere...

PETOSKEY

Grammy Milly gave it to me. It's her last gift.

WAYLAND

How about a trade?

PETOSKEY

The house...

WAYLAND

...for your cool rock. Well, produce it.

PETOSKEY

I wanna put on a show. I need a whole day.

WAYLAND

After the Grande Parade?

LIZZIE

After the Grande Parade.

WAYLAND

Life will be complete with this cool rock.

Wayland departs.

PETOSKEY

And the Lake House under Grampy Willy.

End of "LIFE IS COMPLETE - REPRISE"

LIZZIE

Is the Petoskey back in Skandia?

PETOSKEY

Closer. At the bottom of Pine River.

LIZZIE

That's not closer. How did that happen?

Petoskey imitates Lulu.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)

Lulu? Wait, when did you go to Pine River? It has the fastest rapids in the state. It's dangerous and forbidden! Only Petey and I- Only some of us have canoed there, like Jacob when he was Cherry's teenager...

PETOSKEY

Well back in 2019, Jacob took us on a little detour...

SCENE 4

EXT. LUMBERJACK PARK, AUGUST 2019 - DAY

8. "WILD MIDWEST"

Jacob paces like a sergeant as his cousins stand in formation.

JACOB

You all are not supposed to be here, but here we are now. All thanks to...

COUSINS

Our favorite cousin Jacob...

JACOB

Favorite?

COUSINS

The famous actor Jacob Jacobowitz...

JACOB

These rapids downstream are not an act. Uncle Petey used to take us canoeing until he passed away. So blessed to keep this tradition alive. So, shhhhh. Tell your parents and ya dead meat.

Each canoe needs two rowers. I'll pair you all by ages. Lulu, Petoskey, you're both ten. Liberty, Bailey-

Jacob pairs up each cousins.

Lulu sticks her tongue out at Petoskey in a disgusted manner.

Each team carry in their canoe.

Jacob hands out the paddles.

JACOB (CONT'D)

Here are your paddles. Now each duo must decide their bow and stern.

LULU

Isn't the stern like a lotta work?

JACOB

Affirmative.

LULU & PETOSKEY

I choose the bow! No, you're stern! You lazy good for nothin'-

LULU

Whoever gets soaked first...

PETOSKEY

...has to row these rapids...

JACOB

We've got ourselves a WILD MIDWEST SHOWDOWN!

Lulu and Petoskey walk in opposite directions before turning to face each other. They prepare to draw their water guns.

The Twins leap out and startle Lulu. She sprays them while Petoskey unloads on her.

Lulu lies on the ground, defeated.

PETOSKEY

Get paddling! What? I promised the twins from Hell I'd cover their dad tax for the rest of Harbor Days.

LULU

You're gonna sink, Petoskey...

End of "WILD MIDWEST"

SCENE 5

EXT. PINE RIVER - DAY

Jacob rows on his kayak, leading the canoes downstream. Each canoe is occupied by Lulu and Petoskey, Liberty and Bailey, and others.

JACOB

Our first rapids is dead ahead! Make sure you don't stick the paddles in the sharp rocks.

Lulu sticks a paddle in Petoskey.

LULU

Ya ain't sharp, Petoskey.

PETOSKEY

Forget the water guns. You're getting waterboarded, Lulu.

LULU

Woah! That's messed up, war-crimes boy!

9. "MORE THAN FINE (I'M PINE)"

LIBERTY & BAILEY

It's not the rapids that'll kill you.

BAILEY

It's the pine!

LIBERTY

Or the sand!

JACOB

Okay... Then we should be fine.

The Twins' canoe skids by a pine tree.

BAILEY

Ah! Ah! Pineee!!!

Bailey collapses in the canoe.

LIBERTY

Twin down! Twin down! We gotta ground!

JACOB

What?! What is it?!

As the canoe stops, Liberty touches the sandy ground.

LIBERTY

Ah! Ah! Sandddd!!!

Liberty convulses by the dune.

Jacob docks and tends to Liberty.

JACOB

You didn't tell us you're really allergic to uh-

LIBERTY

Sand!

BAILEY

Pine!

LIBERTY & BAILEY

It's not the rapids that'll kill you.

BAILEY

It's the pine!

LIBERTY

Or the sand!

JACOB

Pine?! Sand?! That's basically Michigan!

PETOSKEY

I know you're from Hell and all but uh...

LULU

Ya gotta stop speaking in riddles.

JACOB

Lulu, Petoskey, you go on ahead.

Liberty and Bailey go dead.

JACOB (CONT'D)

(Crying)

At least you two are in Heaven now.

The Twins sit up spontaneously.

LIBERTY & BAILEY

We're still from Hell. Thanks for making sure we're fine. Please accept these as tokens of our appreciation.

The Twins pull out poison ivy bouquets into Jacob's face.

LIBERTY & BAILEY (CONT'D)

Poison ivy bouquets.

JACOB

Oh Godddd!!!

In another canoe, Liz at the bow
and a shadowy figure at the stern
row by.

PETHEY
WAKEY, WAKEY, SON...

LULU
Wake up, dumdum! We're heading towards the last
rapids-

Lulu hits Petoskey with the paddle
which causes the canoe to capsize.

Underwater, Petoskey loses grip of
the shadowy figure as they vanish.
He realizes the Heirloom is
missing from his neck.

End of "MORE THAN FINE (I'M PINE)"

SCENE 6

EXT. PINE RIVER, AUGUST 2022 - DAY

Liz grabs Petoskey from the water.

LIZZIE
Found your rock, yet?

PETOSKEY
I swear dad was here. I mean *the Petoskey*.

LIZZIE
Liberty, Bailey, getting warmer?

BAILEY
(Smirking)
The water is warmer here...

LIBERTY
Ew...

PETOSKEY
Those two are seriously from Hell.

LIZZIE
They're sweet angels for tagging along and trying to help you find a necklace you lost three years ago...

PETOSKEY
I promised they can pick my costume for next year if they found it.

LIZZIE
What do they want you to wear?

PETOSKEY
Welp, I'd be lucky if they want me to wear anything.

Lulu shows up.

LULU
Mom told me I should help...

PETOSKEY
Wanna help me lose something else?

LULU
Nah, bruh. I'm deciding what you'll wear next Harbor Days! The Sun is directly above us. It won't be dark until...

The Sun falls out of the sky with the Moon instantly replacing her.

SCENE 7

EXT. SLEEPING BEAR DUNES - NIGHT

A bonfire lives by Lulu and
Petoskey.

LULU

No time...

PETOSKEY

No rocks... No father... No sorrys...

10. "DEARBORN (DEAR DEER)"

DEER

ON NIGHTS, A CRESCENT MOON MOCKS ALL THOSE WHO DREAM.
THAT NEVER STOP THESE KIDS FROM SMILING BACK.
THEIR INNER DEER FACES THE MOON LIGHT HEADLIGHTS.
SHE'S BORN TO TAKE OUT HER FRUSTRATION ON A CAR MIRROR.
SHE CARES NOT IF THE SMILING MOON RETURNS AS A FIREFY BALL.
AFTER ALL, SHE HAS THE WATERFALL ON HER SIDE.
WHILE HE'S A ROCK STUCK IN A HARD PLACE.
THERE'S NOT A PUDDLE HE WON'T SKIP.

LULU

DEAR DEER,
WHAT'S IT LIKE TO BE BORN ONE?
DEAREST DEER,
WHEN IT IS TIME TO ASK THE SUN?
DEAR BIRTH,
WHY IS EVERYONE GIVEN A MINUTE, BUT I'M GIVEN A SECOND
DEAR BORN,
SHOW ME DANGER AND I'LL SHARE IT FOR EVERYONE TO RECKON

[Lulu hopes to leave a mark on the
world like a deer and also have a
spiritual connection to the rocks
and fossils much like Petoskey. He
just wants to meet his father.]

End of "DEARBORN (DEAR DEER)"

SCENE 8

EXT. LAKE MICHIGAN SHORES - MORNING

11. "FOSSILS IN THE STONES"

[Next day, while Perry teaches fossils to the kids.]

End of "FOSSILS IN THE STONES"

12. "GICHIGAMIIN (THE GREAT LAKES BALLET)"

Lulu trails off from the group.

As she walks along the coastline of the fourth wall, the Deer approaches from the audience. They drop off the Heirloom and other special rocks and fossils.

Lulu looks over as the Deer dashes away. She finds the rock deposits.

MAGTOGOEK (THE WALKING PATH)

First, Lulu feels a glacial rock. The history of the Great Lakes courses through her. She floats from the Atlantic Ocean into the mainland on St. Lawrence River.

ONIATARI:IO (THE LAKE OF SHINING WATERS)

The Chippewa, Keepers of Tradition, dance and interact.

ERIELHONAN (LONG TAIL)

The Ottawa, Keepers of the Trade, dance and interact.

KAREGNONDI (LAKE)

The Potawatomi, Keepers of the Fire, dance and interact.

MICHIGAMI (GREAT WATER)

The Anishinaabe, Council of Three Fires, come together and dance and interact.

PNW (GREAT SEA)

Lulu touches the Heirloom. Pain strikes her.

17TH-CENTURY FRENCH EXPLORERS, FUR TRADERS, and MISSIONARIES set foot on the shore. They terrorize and scare off the Anishinaabe. One colonizer resembles Petey. He pulls out a sword and prepares to strike down Lulu.

Present-day Shelby intervenes and stops him. The French runs off into the unknown.

End of "GICHIGAMIIN (THE GREAT LAKES BALLET)"

Shelby helps Lulu up.

SHELBY

Ready to go to the parade? Woah, those are some neat-o rocks. Did you go swimming in Lake Michigan? You don't seem all that soaked.

LULU

I dried up super quick-

SHELBY

You scrapped your arm. Don't play with rocks, dear.

LULU

It more so messed with my head. The rocks played with me. For the parade, I've got perfect costume for this problem. A cast.

Lulu gathers the rocks. She holds the Petoskey with resentment.

SCENE 9

EXT. ELK RAPIDS - NOON

The Grande Parade is underway. As Jacob is this year's Grand Marshall, the Vandam's theme is Musical Theatre. The Vandams adjust their costumes and makeup.

Lulu wears an Evan Hansen cast.

Petoskey adjusts his suspenders.

LULU

Who are you supposed to be, Petoskey?

PETOSKEY

Um... Jud- Uh?

LULU

Oh! Jud Fry. That guy suuuuccckkkkssss. He thinks it is O K to beat up women.

PETOSKEY

Are you supposed to be Tiny um Tim um Timmy?

Lulu waves at a window.

LULU

Waving through a window?

PETOSKEY

So, my guy sucks. And your guy's creepy.

The Twins show up as Elphaba and Glinda.

PETOSKEY (CONT'D)

And those two are like- princess witches?

The Twins monkey around.

LULU

Nah, they're flying monkeys! *They're Elphaba and Glinda.* This is Musical Theatre 101.

PETOSKEY

I hate musicals.

Lulu approaches Jacob, who is dressed as Wednesday from *The Addams Family*.

LULU

Wednesday, Jud Fry is against everything you stand for.

JACOB

At least I get to stand at the end unlike Jud Fry. By the way, isn't this so inspiring to you as a musical writer?

A bell rings in the distance.

Jacob heads to his post.

PETOSKEY

How's that musical you're writing?

Lulu pulls out a giant scrapbook with deer stickers.

LULU

Dearborn the musical! It'll have its showcase at my middle school fall talent show! Emma's gonna play Mama Deer, Lukas is Papa Deer, Camille is Cathy Dee- Oh! And Dionne's uh Lake Superior, Lee's gonna be Huron-

Petoskey grows bored and walks away.

LULU (CONT'D)

Where ya goin'?! Eh, I'll have you singing like a canary in front of the family in due time.

Cherry whistles and gather the family together.

CHERRY

This is the parade you all've been waiting for. You'd expect I can give a pep talk, being married to a sport guy, but he's a hockey guy. They don't talk, they beat up. Anyone got some positive news they'd like to share before we proceed?

SHELBY

We've got a new winner for this year's rock collection.

Shelby steps aside to show Lulu in all her glory. She drops most of the rocks on the ground.

LIBERTY & BAILEY

Wooooaaahhhh... Lulu beat Petoskey! Lulu beat Petoskey! Lulu beat Petoskey!

LIZZIE

You didn't happen to buy these at a rock store?

Lulu pulls out the Heirloom.

LULU

Is this proof enough for ya?

LIBERTY & BAILEY

No fair! Lulu's gonna pick what Petoskey wears!

Petoskey tries to nab it, but Lulu pulls back.

LULU

Nah ah ah. This Petoskey's got evil energy.

PETOSKEY

Evil, huh? I'm pure at heart. But you can be a good troll, having the chance to pick what I wear next year.

CHERRY

Let's celebrate the reigning champion, Lulu Abughosh, at BANH MI, after the parade. Now let's get a move on!

13. "FRAUDWAY"

As Perry drives the Ford Model T, Willy sits in the passenger side, and Cherry is in the back seat in the most elaborate costume ever.

The Vandams hand out candy and theatre memorabilia to the parade crowd and real-life audience.

JACOB

And next up is my family! This year's costumed theme is Broadway. *Hmm... I wonder why?*

Jacob points to himself. He goes up to an audience member.

JACOB (CONT'D)

Which family do you think is better? The Vandams family or the Addams family?

Audience Engagement: If an audience member answers: "The Vandams Family," Jacob responds with: "I was on tour with the Addams Family. Did you even see me?" If a member answers: "The Addams Family," Jacob responds with: "But the Addams are not even a real family. The Vandams are weird, but real."

Example

AUDIENCE MEMBER

The Vandams family!

JACOB

Oh come on! I was on tour with the Addams Family. Did you even see me?

AUDIENCE MEMBER

The Addams Family!

JACOB

But the Addams are not even a real family. The Vandams are weird, but real.

End Example

Jacob gets out the 2022 Most Creative Award plaque.

JACOB (CONT'D)

And this year's winner of the 2022 Harbor Days
Most Creative Award is... the Vandams!

VANDAMS

Vandams do! Vandams don't... lose!

LULU & PETOSKEY

(Sarcastically)

What a surprise?!

CHERRY

If we ever lost one of these, I'm disowning ya.

JACOB

I probably shouldn't had the award to mom.
That's a wee bit bias. Someone not blood
related... Ah Lizzie!

Jacob hands the plaque to Lizzie.

In Lulu's perspective, as she is
about to hand over the Heirloom to
Petoskey, Colonizer Petey steps
into her line of sight. She
smashes the Heirloom on the
ground, splitting the hearty
Petoskey stone in half.

In Petoskey's perspective, he sees
his father Petey once more. When
Lulu smashes the Heirloom, Petey
vanishes. Petoskey is scattered
like the Petoskey before him. He
is heartbroken like never before.

The parade reaches BANH MICHIGAN
restaurant. Jasper is handing out
food with the Tran family.

Lulu waves at Jasper.

PETOSKEY

YOU'RE NOT TAKING MY GODFATHER TOO!

Petoskey punches Lulu. It is never
a good look for Jud Fry to beat up
the broken-armed Evan Hansen.

Liz and Shelby try to break up the
fight. Suddenly, a memory washes
over them.

Petey comes out of nowhere and
hurts Shelby. Liz redirects her
attention to them.

PETHEY

They stole our jobs and my little sister, too!

LIZZIE

Petos- Petey, stop! Get your hands off her!

PETHEY

She... She...

PETOSKEY

She... She...

LIZZIE

Her husband is a loving hardworking man. Even if he's a transplant. If you cannot accept her love into your family, I cannot accept joining yours ever again.

PETHEY

I... I...

PETOSKEY

I... I...

Petey tries to hug or kiss Liz.
She dismisses and tends to Shelby.

Petey exits and starts up the car.

In reality, Jasper pulls Petoskey away from Lulu.

Jacob runs into the orchestra pit and blows a wind instrument.

End of "FRAUDWAY"

JACOB

The parade is over! We do not condone these acts of violence. Huh... On behalf of the Harbor Days committee, I hereby revoke my family's Most Creative Award.

A Resident removes the award plaque from Willy's grasp.

14. "KICK ROCKS"

Petoskey faces Liz.

PETOSKEY

PLEASE SEE, MOM. IT'S NOT WHAT IT LOOK LIKE.
BELIEVE ME, MOM. I AIN'T MEAN TO HURT HER.
DON'T LEAVE ME, MOM! SHE STARTED EVERYTHING.

LIZZIE

SON...
GO KICK ROCKS!
KICK ROCKS!
IT DOESN'T MATTER WHO'S START IT!
AS MY CHILD, YOU KNOW BETTER...

PETOSKEY
VIOLENCE WON'T END?

Lizzie levels herself with
Petoskey before distancing away.

LIZZIE
SON...
WHAT MATTERS, VIOLENCE IS NOT THE ANSWER!

PETOSKEY
A RAGING MONSTER'S WHAT I LOOK LIKE.
BEEN A MONSTER, WHO IS MEANT TO HURT ALL.
DO LEAVE THIS MONSTER, WHO'S STONED EVERYTHING.

LIZZIE
SON...
GO
KICK ROCKS!

The Vandams join in with Liz,
except Lulu who remains silent.

VANDAMS
KICK ROCKS!

LIZZIE
IT DOESN'T MATTER WHO'S START IT.

PETOSKEY
I DIDN'T START IT!

VANDAMS
WHO STARTED IT?

LIZZIE
MAYBE AS MY HUSBAND'S CHILD, YOU DON'T KNOW BETTER...

VANDAMS
THE VIOLENCE WON'T END!

Lulu is about to lodge a punch at
Petoskey. Instead, she throws the
Heirloom at him.

Petoskey ponders about the
Mackinac Bridge.

PETOSKEY
ALL THAT MATTER'S THAT WE BRIDGE THE LOVE...
IT'S ALWAYS THE ANSWER!

Petoskey faces a body of water.

LIZZIE
SON,
KICK ROCKS!

	LIZZIE (CONT'D)	VANDAMS
KICK ROCKS!		KICK ROCKS!
WHY PETOSKEY?		KICK ROCKS!

	VANDAMS (CONT'D)
KICK ROCKS!	
KICK ROCKS!	

Liz reaches for Petoskey.

	LIZZIE
NO!	

	VANDAMS
KICK...	

	LULU
REMEMBER TO FLOAT!	

	LIZZIE
PETOSKEY!	

	VANDAMS
...ROCKS!	

Like his father, Petoskey leaps
and sinks into the body of water.

End of "KICK ROCKS"

END OF ACT I

INTERMISSION

ACT II

SCENE 1

EXT. ELK RAPIDS, AUGUST 2016 - DAY

15. "HANDS COME IN HANDY"

The Harbor Days talent show has a handy line-up, including 7-year-old Lulu and Petoskey.

LULU
WELCOME TO MICHIGAN.
ARE YOU FEELING LOST?
ALWAYS REMEMBER, FRIEND:
PUT YOUR RIGHT PALM UP.

PETOSKEY
OR FACE YOUR LEFT HAND DOWN!

LULU
PUT YOUR RIGHT PALM UP.

PETOSKEY
AND YOUR LEFT HAND OVER!

Petoskey puts his left hand, palm facing, over Lulu's right hand to form Michigan's Peninsulas. They point to the respective cities.

LULU & PETOSKEY
LET'S START WITH THE THUMB.
DETROIT, DEARBORN, WARREN, PORT HURON, FLINT, HAMTRAMCK,
ROYAL OAK, AND DON'T FORGET ANN ARBOR.
HANDS COME IN HANDY!

PETOSKEY
WHAT BRINGS YOU TO MICHIGAN?
WE DO HAVE THE BEST SOCKS!

LULU
DON'T FORGET THE MITTENS!

PETOSKEY
PUT YOUR LEFT PALM DOWN.

LULU
OR FACE YOUR *RIGHT* PALM UP!

PETOSKEY
PUT YOUR RIGHT PALM UP.

LULU
AND YOUR LEFT HAND OVER!

LULU & PETOSKEY
LET'S POINT TO THE PALM.
LANSING, MT. PLEASANT, SAGINAW, KALAMAZOO, CLAIRE, SAINT
LOUIS, GRAND RAPIDS, AND LET'S FORGET WYOMING...
HANDS COME IN HANDY!

Lulu and Petoskey wear Wyoming High School gears (David Quang Pham's alma mater).

LULU & PETOSKEY (CONT'D)
NOW AROUND THE HAND...
ST. JOSEPH, SAUGATUCK, HOLLAND, GRAND HAVEN, MUSKEGON,
TRAVERSE CITY, ALPENA...

Petoskey points to himself.

LULU
WHO COULD FORGET PETOSKEY...?

LULU & PETOSKEY
HANDS COME IN HANDY!

NOW THE OTHER HAND!
MARQUETTE, ESCANABA, HOUGHTON, SAULT STE. MARIE, MACKINAC,
IRON MOUNTAIN, KEWEENAW.

LULU
DID WE FORGET ANYTHING?

Petoskey brings out Snoopy.

PETOSKEY
MICHIGAN'S ADVENTURES!

TWO PARKS!

PETOSKEY
FOR THE PRICE OF ONE!

FUN! FUN!

LULU	PETOSKEY
MICHIGAN'S LOWER PENINSULA!	MICHIGAN'S UPPER PENINSULA!

LULU & PETOSKEY
FOR A THOUSAND TOWNSHIPS, TOWNSHIPS!

Lulu and Petoskey go into the audience and applaud them.

LULU & PETOSKEY (CONT'D)

APPLAUD EACH OTHER!
APPLAUD YOURSELVES!

LOVE MICHIGAN!
DON'T EVER FEEL LOST!
REMEMBER TO USE YOUR HANDS!
HANDS COME IN HANDY!

LULU
PUT YOUR RIGHT PALM UP.

PETOSKEY
LEFT HAND OVER!

LULU & PETOSKEY
HANDS COME IN HANDY!

Lulu and Petoskey do a Pat-a-cake,
pat-a-cake, baker's man game.

End of "HANDS COME IN HANDY"

SCENE 2

INT. ELK LAKE HOUSE, AUGUST 2022 - DAY

Liz watches the 2016 recording of
Lulu and Petoskey's handy song.

LIZZIE
I guess Petoskey could be anywhere!

Cherry and Perry check in.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)
My son?

CHERRY
No luck.

PERRY
You should've named him Limestone. He would've
been easier to find.

LIZZIE
Science is not helping.

CHERRY
When did it ever?

EXT. ELK LAKE HOUSE - DAY

Cherry and Perry go outside to
find many search parties.

16. "PETOSKEY"

[Presently, they search for him while Lulu tries to find him
at BANH MI ("Petoskey").]

End of "PETOSKEY"

SCENE 3

INT. BANH MICHIGAN - DAY

Lulu enters the restaurant and
sits by Jasper on the phone.

JASPER

You won't accept the cash prize? Fine. I'll
give you the BANH MICHIGAN secret formula if
you find him. Of course *alive*, you sicko.

Jasper hangs up.

JASPER (CONT'D)

You found Petoskey?

Lulu faces down on the table,
crying.

JASPER (CONT'D)

Don't lose yourself, Lulu...

LULU

I lost my cousin. I lost my family. I lost all
hope.

[Jasper shares his refugee family stayed united despite
continents dividing them as well as a time when a Lebanese
family bought out his family's failing restaurant but did not
resort to blame as Petey had. The Vandams are only divided by
peninsulas.]

JASPER

You know what my family always said?

LULU

No, I don't.

17. "NORTH SOUTH EAST WEST"

LULU

YOUR FAMILY SAID WHAT?

JASPER

NORTH SOUTH EAST OR WEST.
IT DOESN'T MATTER WHERE YOU COME FROM
AS LONG AS YOU BREAK BREAD.

LULU

YOU AND YA BANH MI NEEDA GIVE IT A REST.

JASPER

SOMEONE'S COMPASS AIN'T PASSING MY TEST.

Jacob enters the restaurant.

JACOB
SHALOM.

LULU
BONJOUR!

JASPER
CHAU, JACOB!

JACOB
LOOKING FOR OUR MISSING COUSIN WORKED ME UP AN APPETITE.

JASPER
I'M SURE KOSHER WILL GIVE US CLOSURE.

JACOB
MAKE MY BREAD A BRIDGE ROLL.

JASPER
NOT FEELING FRENCH TODAY?

LULU
THE BRITISH INVASION WAS SO YESTERDAY.

Jasper makes a banh mi for Jacob.

JASPER
NORTH SOUTH EAST OR WEST.
I DON'T CARE IF YOU'RE STRAIGHT OR CURVED
SO LONG AS YOU TRY THEM BAGUETTES.

JACOB
Just cause I do musical theatre does not make
me gay. Look at Lulu, wanting to be a musical
writer, does that make her-

LULU
Yup, I'm gay.

JASPER
Open-and-shut case.

JACOB
Okay...

LULU
Banh mi turned me gay.

JASPER
Case back open...

JACOB
Haha! Welp...
TODA FOR THE BRIDGE!

LULU
THE BRIDGE?

JASPER
THE MACKINAC BRIDGE.

LULU
THE MACKINAC BRIDGE.

JASPER
THE MACKINAC BRIDGE.

LULU
THE MACKINAC.

LULU & JASPER
THE MACKINAC BRIDGE.

NORTH SOUTH EAST OR WEST.
IT DOESN'T MATTER WHERE YOU GO
SO LONG AS YOU LISTEN TO THE BREAD.

End of "NORTH SOUTH EAST WEST"

Liz enters the restaurant.

LULU & JASPER (CONT'D)
We know where Petoskey is.

LIZZIE
I have a feeling, it's...

JASPER
The bridge...

LIZZIE
I...

JASPER
I'll go to Mackinac for you.

LULU
And I need to go apologize...

Liz punches her hand into her
other hand. Lulu acknowledges it.

LULU (CONT'D)
Apologize with some deserved violence.

Jasper kisses a banh mi.

JASPER
Banh mi, you never fail me!

Lulu and Jasper run out.

SCENE 4

EXT. MACKINAC BRIDGE - DAY

18. "ROCK BOTTOM"

Petoskey looks down at the strait.

PETOSKEY

...

[Lulu and Jasper drive up to find him. She offers the broken stone as a truce.]

Petoskey chucks the heirloom,
surprising Lulu.

End of "ROCK BOTTOM"

19. "FAMILY'S IN THE FOSSILS"

The bridge fogs up, separating
Petoskey from Lulu and Jasper.

In the mist, a GIANT ELK towers
Petoskey. He cowers below them.

PETHEY
WAKEY WAKEY, SON...

PETOSKEY
WAKEY WAKEY... PETHEY? DAD?

PETHEY
Turning into an elk, I gained a couple hundred
pounds. But luckily, I'm a *ghost*!

Petey awaits laughter.

PETHEY (CONT'D)
I guess you're not used to dad jokes...

PETOSKEY
Nah, I'm used to Jasper's.

PETHEY
How is he? Still run that restaurant?

PETOSKEY
BANH MIchigan.

PETHEY
There's unlimited Banh Mi in the afterlife, but
it doesn't hit like BANH MIchigan.

PETOSKEY
And unlimited souls?

PETHEY
Yeah, but never one like your mom. Lizzie.

PETOSKEY
Dad, why did you leave her? Us?

PETHEY
Son, there's more to life than the house. And
obviously more to my niece than you thought.

PETOSKEY
Lulu and I will never get along...

PETHEY
I only wished my younger sister Shelby and I
had a friendship like her daughter and yours.

[Petey shares that stones are special only when rocks are packed together. Like family, living things come and go to leave a mark as a fossil ("Family's in the Fossils").

The fog clears up, showing a
confused Lulu and confident
Petoskey.

Petoskey runs up and hugs Lulu.

LULU
I'd punch you off this bridge...

PETOSKEY
Thanks for having mercy on me...

Lulu and Petoskey walk away from
the Mackinac Bridge.

A punch is audible.

PETOSKEY (O.S.) (CONT'D)
Ouch! Ope...

LULU (O.S.)
Told ya I'd punch ya off the bridge!

JASPER (O.S.)
Hold your vengeance for Amanda Wayland and her
cronies!

LULU, PETOSKEY, JASPER
Let's save Elk Rapids!

They drive off.

END OF ACT II

ACT III**SCENE 1****EXT. ELK RAPIDS - DAY****20. "LEAVE NO STONES UNTURNED"**

[They return to the fair where Wayland is exhibiting data center models with other developers. Petoskey offers the Ford which she scoffs but is interested in. Jasper then offers his restaurant and golf course. The Vandams return with decades of themed costume while Wayland shows how much "better" AI is.]

WAYLAND

Look at them. Using their own humanity to bring messy creativity to the world. What a shame.

RESIDENT

What a shame? It's *who* and that's you.

WAYLAND

Me? The shame would be on me if I leave the city of stones unturned.

RESIDENT

We don't need another city turned into a data center.

RESIDENTS

Yeah!

WAYLAND

Data Rapids has a nice ring to it.

RESIDENT

The Vandam is our ring...

RESIDENT (CONT'D)

And we're committed to them.

RESIDENT (CONT'D)

Vandams! Vandams! Vandams!

WAYLAND

Activate Elk dot AI!

Everyone's phone pings. They get distracted.

RESIDENT

Check out this cute elk doing karate!

RESIDENT (CONT'D)

My elk is doing a comedy routine!

RESIDENT (CONT'D)

And this is Aretha Franklin as an elk!

Wayland and the Oligarchs make
their way through the distracted
crowd to the Ford Model T.

Lulu and Petoskey block Wayland.

PETOSKEY

We don't have our phones.

LULU

Our parents grounded us.

Holding a frying pan, Milly sneaks
behind Wayland and the oligarchs.
She knocks them out.

LULU & PETOSKEY

Grammy Milly!

Lulu and Petoskey go to hug Milly.
She stops them.

MILLY

Ope ope ope... You need baths. But first, want
me wipe a batch of your favorite cookies?! I
don't want your dirty butts in the backseat, so
get in the trunk.

LULU & PETOSKEY

Anything for you, Grammy!

Lulu and Petoskey get in the
trunk. Milly closes it then
vanishes.

Wayland and the Oligarchs get up.

WAYLAND

Works every time...

The residents face Wayland.

VANDAMS

Those wealth hoarders are kidnapping our kids!

RESIDENTS

Get them!

The Ford Model T drives away from
the pursuing crowd.

OLIGARCH

Is it morally right to lock kids in the trunk?

OLIGARCH (CONT'D)

We can sell them for parts!

OLIGARCH (CONT'D)

I love being rich!

WAYLAND

Elk Rapids, check. Next, Grand Rapids!

The GHOST OF HENRY FORD manifests
inside the Ford Model T, chained
up like a Charles Dickens ghost.

WAYLAND (CONT'D)

The ghost of Henry Ford???!

OLIGARCHS

Our lord and savior...

WAYLAND

What happened to you?

FORD

This is what anti-Semitism and being anti-union
does to you. Distribute your wealth or else!

OLIGARCH

Well, at least there's cryptocurrency.

FORD

We have the internet in Hell, too. You think
angels invented WIFI?!

WAYLAND

Get off my plane of existence!

Wayland drives off a bridge.

The Vandams and the townspeople
reach the wreckage.

LIZZIE

Driving off bridges is not the best idea. But
you ain't alone.

WAYLAND

The ghost of Ford is here!

RESIDENTS

Gerald R. Ford?!

WAYLAND & OLIGARCHS

Henry!

RESIDENTS

They're insane...

The cops arrest Wayland and the
oligarchs.

CHERRY

Cops arresting oligarchs.

PERRY

This ain't real life.

SHELBY

There's a reason.

COP

We've always been arresting the mentally ill.

JACOB

And you're gonna throw them in an asylum
without due process?

COP

Yup. That ain't gonna change.

LIBERTY & BAILEY

Excellent. Muahahaha!

JASPER

Technically, once their party is declared
insane, it voids their contracts after they
have held this entire city hostage.

VANDAMS

The Lake House is ours!

RESIDENTS

All our houses are back!

Lulu and Petoskey are still in the
trunk of the Ford Model T.

LULU & PETOSKEY

Elk Rapids! Elk Rapids!

Liz and Shelby open the trunk,
releasing Lulu and Petoskey.

RESIDENTS

Hurray! Lulu and Petoskey! Lulu and Petoskey!

The Vandams and the townspeople
rally around Lulu and Petoskey.

LULU & PETOSKEY

Let's celebrate at BANH Michigan!

Everyone leaves Lulu and Petoskey.

End of "LEAVE NO STONES UNTURNED"

SCENE 2

EXT. ELK LAKE HOUSE - DAY

Lulu goes sit by Elk Lake and drop her rocks as Petoskey watches.

Jasper takes down the last tent while the sisters toss candy at him in admiration.

JASPER

There's 'nough sweets to go around... with kid representation upon dad taxation.

LIZZIE

And mom taxation!

Liz nabs candy from Jasper's hand.

LIBERTY & BAILEY

Grampy Willy, can we have some candy.

WILLY

I'm Willy. Not Willy Wonka. Ask them two tax collectors over there.

As wild beasts, the Twins eye Liz and Jasper. They chase them out.

Petoskey joins Lulu by Elk Lake.

PETOSKEY

The reigning champion of this year's rock competition. By a landslide.

LULU

I got help from an Elk. Wanna help skip them?

Audience Engagement: Petoskey and Lulu face the audience. They toss rocks until someone yells: "Ow!"

AUDIENCE MEMBER

Ow!

LULU

Oh dear!

PETOSKEY

Someone's swimming here.

LULU

(Canadian)

Sorry, eh.

PETOSKEY

Rocky start.

LULU

Rocky end.

LULU & PETOSKEY

Wouldn't want it any other way.

Lulu and Petoskey hug.

Jacob stumbles in with his phone.

JACOB

Guys and dolls! Guess what?

VANDAMS

What?!

JACOB

O K!

VANDAMS

Oklahoma? Where the wind comes sweeping down
the plain? You're moving there?

JACOB

No no no. I'm joining the revival of *Oklahoma*!

LULU

As long as you're not Jud Fry.

VANDAMS

(staring down Petoskey)

Yeah, that guy succckkkkkkssssss.

PETOSKEY

Mom, I think the Trolls have 'nough of us...

LIZZIE

Before we make a run for it... Willy, may I
take the Model T for a spin?

WILLY

Drive it off another bridge and Henry Ford will
roll in his grave.

Henry Ford manifests.

FORD

You have my blessing.

Lulu and the Twins spot Ford. They
chase out the ghost of Henry Ford.

LULU

You bigot!

LIBERTY & BAILEY

See you in Hell, Henry Ford!

PETOSKEY

Told ya they ain't angels.

LIZZIE

They have inner demons they need to face...

Liz starts up the Ford Model T.
Petoskey hops in.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)

Son... We're taking the shortcut.

Liz and Petoskey wave bye to all.

SCENE 3

EXT. MACKINAC BRIDGE - DAY

21. "WATER TO MY SOUL"

On the foggy bridge is the broken
Heirloom.

Liz drives towards the outskirts
of the bridge. She motions for
Petoskey to stay put. She walks
alone on the bridge.

LIZZIE

WHEN? WHEN? WHEN? WHEN?
WHEN WILL I EVER LET GO?

MACKINAC GHOSTS

WHEN YOU OPEN YOUR EYES AND SEE THE PAIN SHOW...

LIZZIE

WHERE? WHERE? WHERE? WHERE?
WHERE DO ALL MY TEARS FLOW?

MACKINAC GHOSTS (CONT'D)

WHERE? WHERE?
FLOW?

The Ghosts step aside to reveal
Petey in all his glory.

MACKINAC GHOSTS (CONT'D)

WELL YOU JUST HAVE TO ASK THIS POOR SOUL...

LIZZIE

MY POOR SOUL...

PETEY

NOW A HAPPY SOUL...

LIZZIE & PETEY

YOU ARE WATER TO MY SOUL...

LIZZIE

WHERE YOU GO.

PETHEY

I'LL FLOW!

MACKINAC GHOSTS

NO MATTER WHERE I GO I WILL FLOW...

LIZZIE

UPSTREAM.

PETHEY

DOWNSTREAM.

MACKINAC GHOSTS

YOU ARE WATER TO MY SOUL...

Liz and Petey kiss.

LIZZIE & PETHEY

YOU ARE WATER TO MY SOUL...

MY SOUL...

YOU ARE MY SOUL!

They share a final dance before he
hands his broken Heirloom to her.
She joins Petoskey.

Liz and Petoskey wave as Petey
vanishes with the other ghosts
once more into the foggy bridge.

Liz puts the Heirloom on Petoskey.

They finally cross the bridge.

End of "WATER TO MY SOUL"

END OF ACT III

EPILOGUESCENE 1

EXT. ELK RAPIDS, 2037 - DAY

21A. "LIFE IS COMPLETE - REPRISE 2"

The Vandams prepare themselves for
the Harbor Days Grande Parade.

LIZZIE
(Narrating)

Year after year, still doing Harbor Days. Every
time, I'm there. I *can* cross bridge. Yay me,
facing my trauma. Huh...

And Lulu ended up turning our life story into a
musical for her high school senior year project
then she developed it at U of M...

VANDAMS

Ew...

Lulu flips them off before turning
her hand back into a mitten.

LIZZIE

Two of her musicals, *Dearborn* and *Elk Rapids*,
about a deer colony and anthropomorphic lakes?
They are now touring in a town near you. These
musicals helped raise funds to keep the Lake
House when the time came when Willy is no
longer paying the property taxes.

Lulu and Petoskey fix up the Lake
House.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)

Petoskey worked the shipyard like me and his
father. And he used such skills to fix up the
Lake House. As long as Amanda Wayland doesn't
touch a patch of grass, it's a win for us.

Cherry secretly holds a tablet and
places Willy-Milly's photo on it.

Willy and Milly manifest, lost
once again in the audience.

Cherry waves. Perry and Shelby run
in and mess with Cherry.

The rest of the Vandams come and
watch the Great Lakes together.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)

The Great Lakes is water to our souls...

End of "LIFE IS COMPLETE - REPRISE 2"

SCENE 2

EXT. LANSING, JANUARY 26, 2037 - DAY

The Michigan Bicentennial Parade
ramps up in the state capital.

Jacob is dressed like Eminem.

JACOB

My palms be sweaty, knees weak, arms are heavy.

Cherry hands spaghetti to Jacob.

JACOB (CONT'D)

Love my mom's spaghetti~

Welcome to Michigan's Bicentennial Celebration!
Thanks for inviting me as your Grand Marshall.
Last I hosted a parade it was Elk Rapids Harbor
Days in 2022. Since then, I have won several
Tony Awards and a few Razzies. Them cameras
make my hands look big.

Anywho, as you know, Michigan officially became
the 26th state in the United States on January
26, 1837. As this year is the 200th anniversary
of our statehood, we thought what better way to
celebrate the Mitten then to share the best of
our home state! Today is Pure Michigan!

We have floats and organizations representing
the nearly three hundred cities and a thousand
townships from all over our Great Lakes state!

And here comes Elk Rapids with the world-class
Vandam family!

The Vandam family resembles the
state's best from Aretha Franklin,
Charles Lindbergh, Madonna, Stevie
Wonder, to Christopher Wright
(author of Pham's favorite book
series, *Michigan Chillers*).

JACOB (CONT'D)

Who are we?!

22. "MICHIGAN"

MICHIGANDERS

OPE.

BRR...

WINTER IN OUR BONES.

LIZZIE

WHO M I?

MICHIGANDERS

WATER TO OUR SOULS!

PERRY

AM I KEEPING IT CHILL!

MICHIGANDERS

M I? M I?

CHERRY

AM I HEARTWARMING!

MICHIGANDERS

M I? M I?

SHELBY

AM I FULL OF FREE WILL!

MICHIGANDERS

M I? M I?

M I MICHIGAN!

End of "MICHIGAN"

LOVE MICHIGAN